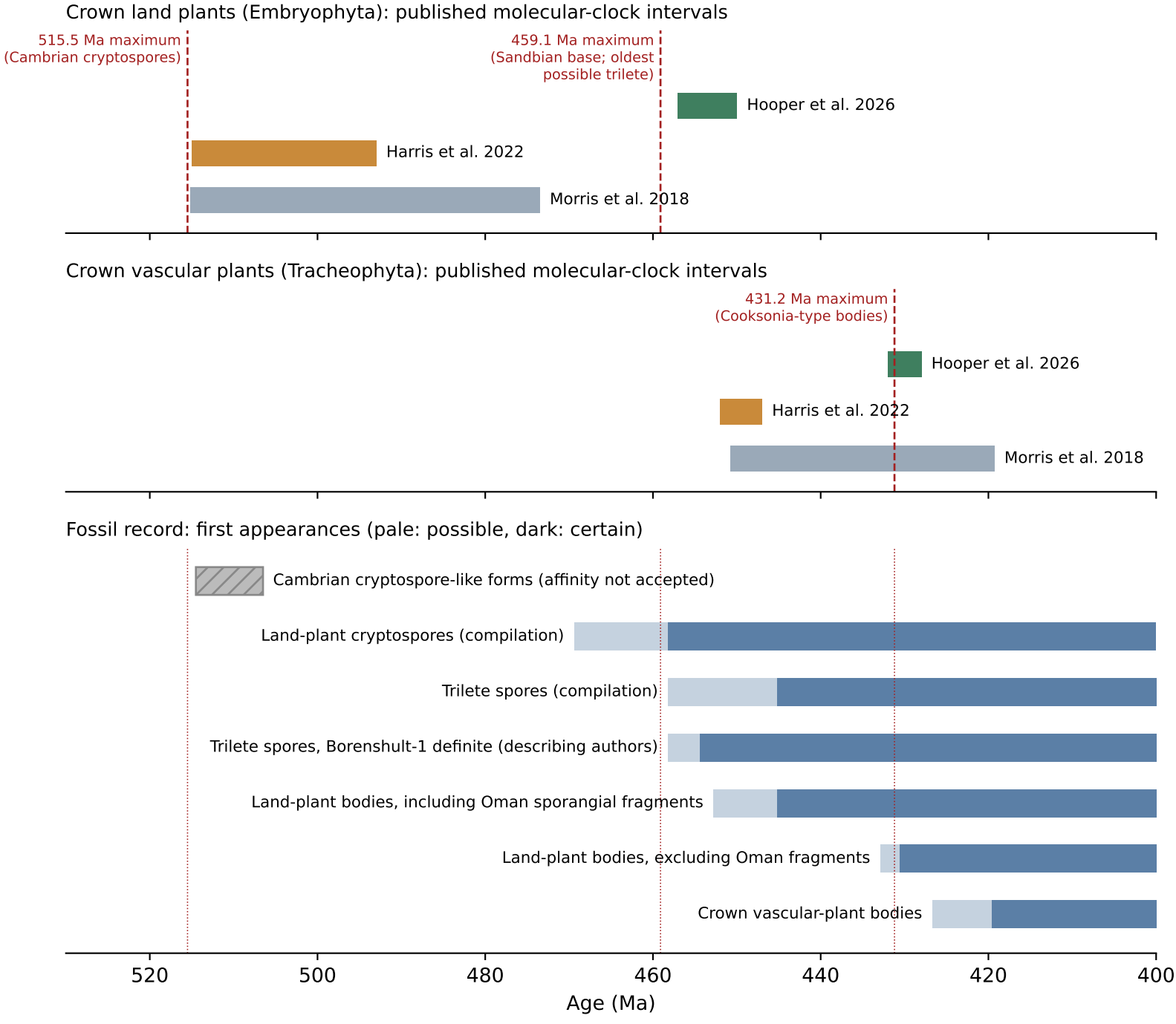
Crown land plants (Embryophyta): published molecular-clock intervals
515.5 Ma maximum
(Cambrian cryptospores)
459.1 Ma maximum
(Sandbian base; oldest
possible trilete)
Hooper et al. 2026
Harris et al. 2022
Morris et al. 2018
Crown vascular plants (Tracheophyta): published molecular-clock intervals
431.2 Ma maximum
(Cooksonia-type bodies)
Hooper et al. 2026
Harris et al. 2022
Morris et al. 2018
Fossil record: first appearances (pale: possible, dark: certain)
Cambrian cryptospore-like forms (affinity not accepted)
Land-plant cryptospores (compilation)
Trilete spores (compilation)
Trilete spores, Borenshult-1 definite (describing authors)
Land-plant bodies, including Oman sporangial fragments
Land-plant bodies, excluding Oman fragments
Crown vascular-plant bodies
520
500
480
460
440
420
400
Age (Ma)